



The stem also has growing points that give rise to many trailing side-shoots. These should be cut out, and the main stem tied to a stake. When the plant reaches the top of the stake, remove its growing tip. A few varieties have aspects of both bush and vine and require minimal trimming; merely tie them to a stake. Plants will need regular feeding with tomato fertilizer.

HARVESTING

Gather fruits once they have attained their full color and have begun to soften. They will not keep long in storage.

PESTS AND DISEASES

In greenhouses, caterpillars, whitefly, and red spider mite may be a problem. Tomatoes also share several problems with potatoes, such as potato cyst eel worm and potato blight. Outdoor crops are prone to blight in cool damp weather; its effects can be devastating.



Tomato blight causes fruits to rot.